FOREWORD

It is my great pleasure to preface this book by N. Elahi, an old and valued friend, whose insights have helped me considerably to shape my perceptions of Pakistan. Mr Elahi has been closely observing Pakistan's struggle against terrorism for the past 15 years, with profound insights into the conduct and structures of the counter-terrorism campaign. This book is therefore not only a work of analysis, but also an important historical document in its own right.

Mr Elahi gives a vivid picture of the well-known struggle of Pakistan against terrorism. Furthermore, this book is highly objective and unbiased. Previously there has been both Pakistani and Western commentators engaging in hysterical denunciations and wild conspiracy theories.

One of the valuable features of this book is that it is eminently sensible in its treatment of foreign involvement in the Tehreek-e-Taliban rebellion. It not only draws attention to the alleged role of the Afghan and Indian intelligence services in sheltering the Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP) remnants who took refuge in Afghanistan and from there have continued their attacks on Pakistan, but also makes it clear that the origin, leadership and membership of the TTP have been – tragically – Pakistani. Mr Elahi rightly attributes the explosion of Pakistani militancy after 2001 to the side-effects of the US invasion of Afghanistan, as well as draws attention to the roots of the TTP rebellion in local traditions and resentments, and to the breakdown of the former indirect system of rule in Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA).

Mr Elahi is both clear-sighted and sympathetic (a rare combination) in his portrayal of why so many Pakistanis – including Pakistani